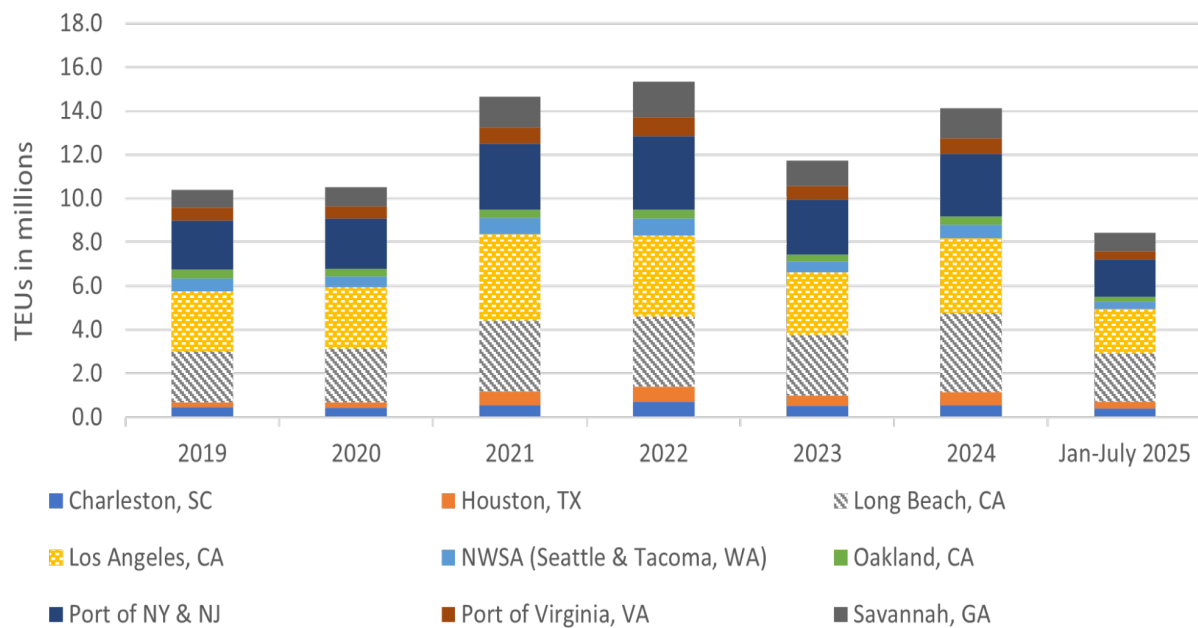




1. Background

This updated stacked bar chart presents annual container volumes (in millions of TEUs) from 2019 through January–July 2025 across major U.S. ports. Several port categories now include hatched patterns—such as diagonal and crosshatch fills—to enhance visual separation and accessibility without changing the underlying color palette.

2. Text Contrast

The white text for axis labels, tick marks, and legend entries remains clear and readable against the black background. Gridlines maintain adequate contrast. The addition of hatching does not impair label visibility, as all text remains external to the bar segments.

3. Graphic (Slice) Contrast

The updated design significantly improves slice differentiation. Previously similar midtone colors, particularly gray and yellow-based categories, now include hatch overlays. These patterns provide stronger visual separation for stacked segments, especially where values produce thin slices. This enhances interpretability without altering the chart's color meaning.

4. Color-Blind Safety

Patterned fills greatly improve accessibility for users with red–green or blue–yellow color vision deficiencies. The hatch overlays provide a non-color cue, helping distinguish categories that previously appeared similar. Some colors without patterns may still be difficult for certain users, but overall accessibility is notably improved.

5. OCR / Text Size

Axis labels, year labels, and legend entries remain large enough for OCR extraction. Since no text appears within bar segments, patterns do not interfere with OCR recognition. The visual clarity of labels is preserved despite the increased complexity of the bar fills.

6. Blur & DPI

The hatched patterns remain crisp and stable at the current resolution. Fine diagonal lines reproduce cleanly without pixelation. For printing or high-quality accessibility use, a source export of at least 300 DPI is recommended to prevent moiré effects or hatch distortion.

7. Alt Text Recommendation

A recommended 508-compliant alt text description: “ Updated stacked bar chart showing annual container volumes in millions of TEUs from 2019 to January–July 2025. Several port categories now use hatched patterns to improve accessibility while retaining their original colors. TEU totals peak in 2021–2022, decline in 2023, rise again in 2024, and decrease in early 2025. ”